PADHAKU
Democratic Politics · Class 10 Social Science



CHAPTER 2

Federalism

NCERT Exercise Solutions

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✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡 answers are samples: write your own.

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🤔 Think · What is federalism?

? I am confused. What do we call the Indian government? Is it Union, Federal or Central?

✔ ANSWER

All three words are used, in different senses:

- **Union:** the Constitution calls India a **'Union of States'**, so the national government is officially the **Union Government**.
- **Central:** in everyday use we call the same government the **Central Government** (the Centre).
- **Federal:** the word 'federation' is not used in the Constitution, but the Indian Union is **based on the principles of federalism**, so it is a federal government.

So the Union Government and the Central Government are the same; 'federal' describes the system.

? Only 25 of the world's 193 countries are federations, but most large countries are federations. Can you notice an exception to this rule in this map?

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- **China**, one of the largest countries in area and population, is **not** shown on the map: it is a large country but not a federation.

- Also, some very small countries are federations, e.g. **St. Kitts and Nevis, Comoros, Micronesia** and **Belgium**.

So federalism is not only for large countries.

? **If federalism works only in big countries, why did Belgium adopt it?**

✔ ANSWER

- Federalism is not only about size; it is a way to **accommodate diversity**.
- Belgium is small but has two main language communities (Dutch and French speakers) with tension between them.
- In **1993** it gave regional governments constitutional powers not dependent on the Centre, so each community could run its own affairs.
- This kept the country united and avoided a civil war like Sri Lanka's.

💬 Discuss · Federalism in Nepal

? **Some Nepalese citizens discussed adopting federalism in their new constitution:**

Khag Raj: I don't like federalism. It would lead to reservation of seats for different caste groups as in India.

Sarita: Ours is not a very big country. We don't need federalism.

Babu Lal: I am hopeful that the Terai areas will get more autonomy if they get their own state government.

Ram Ganesh: I like federalism because powers earlier enjoyed by the king will now be exercised by our elected representatives.

What would be your response to each? Which reflect a wrong understanding of federalism?

✔ ANSWER

- **Khag Raj (wrong):** federalism means dividing power between levels of government. Reservation of seats for castes is a separate policy, not a part of federalism.
- **Sarita (wrong):** federalism is not only for big countries. Small countries like Belgium and Switzerland are federations because they have diversity to accommodate.
- **Babu Lal (correct):** federalism gives regions their own government with powers of their own, so the Terai areas can get more autonomy.
- **Ram Ganesh (wrong):** moving power from a king to elected representatives is **democracy**, not federalism. Federalism is about sharing power between the central and state governments.

So Khag Raj, Sarita and Ram Ganesh show a wrong understanding.

✏️ Think · What makes India a federal country?

? **The Constitution did not use the word federation. Isn't that strange? Did our constitution makers not know about federalism? Or did they wish to avoid talking about it?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- The makers knew federalism well; the Constitution has all its features (two tiers, three lists, independent courts).
- India had just gone through a **painful and bloody Partition**, and princely states were joining the country.
- So they chose the words **'Union of States'** to stress that the Union is **indestructible** and states cannot break away. India is a 'holding together' federation, not a union formed by states' agreement.
- The system is federal in practice; only the word was avoided to stress unity.

? **If agriculture and commerce are state subjects, why do we have ministers of agriculture and commerce in the Union cabinet?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Only 'agriculture' and 'trade and commerce' within a State are State subjects; many related matters are in the Union or Concurrent List, e.g. foreign trade, inter-State trade, banking.
- The Union makes national policies and schemes, gives money to States, handles imports/exports, prices and agricultural research.
- So the Union ministers deal with national-level matters and coordination, while States manage their own farming and trade.

Activity **Listen to one national and one regional news bulletin of All India Radio daily for one week. List news items about government policies or decisions under: only the Central Government; only your or any other State Government; the relationship between the Central and State Governments.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Model table (fill in from your own week of listening):

Only Central Government	Only State Government	Centre–State relations
Union Budget / RBI decision on interest rates	State announces free bus travel for women	Centre releases GST share / funds to States

New defence deal or foreign visit by PM	State police recruitment drive	Dispute over river water or Governor's role
Railways starts new trains	State Board exam results	Centre and State jointly launch a health scheme

Notice that the regional bulletin carries more State news, and some news shows cooperation or conflict between the two levels.

1 **Pokharan lies in Rajasthan. Suppose the Government of Rajasthan opposed the Centre's nuclear policy. Could it prevent the Government of India from conducting nuclear tests?**

✔ ANSWER

No. Defence is in the **Union List**, so only the Union Government decides on it. A State government cannot stop the Centre on a Union subject.

2 **Suppose the Government of Sikkim plans new textbooks for its schools, but the Union Government does not like them. Does the State need the Union's permission before launching them?**

✔ ANSWER

No. Education is in the **Concurrent List**, so the State can make its own decisions. It does not need permission; only if a State law conflicts with a Union law on education does the Union law prevail.

3 **Suppose the Chief Ministers of Andhra Pradesh, Chhattisgarh and Orissa have different policies on how their police should respond to naxalites. Can the Prime Minister pass an order that all Chief Ministers must obey?**

✔ ANSWER

No. Police is in the **State List**. Each State government decides its own police policy and is not answerable to the Centre. The PM can only advise, help and coordinate (e.g. send central forces when States ask).

⭐ Find out · Linguistic States

1 **Has your village / town / city remained under the same State since Independence? If not, what was the name of the earlier State?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Model answer: My town Raipur was in **Madhya Pradesh** till 2000; it is now the capital of **Chhattisgarh**. (Write about your own place.)

Other examples: places in Gurugram were in Punjab till 1966 (now Haryana); Dehradun was in Uttar Pradesh till 2000 (now Uttarakhand).

2 **Can you identify names of three States in 1947 that have been changed later?**

✔ ANSWER

- **Madras → Tamil Nadu**
- **Mysore → Karnataka**
- **United Provinces → Uttar Pradesh**

(Also: Orissa → Odisha.)

3 **Identify any three States which have been carved out of bigger States.**

✔ ANSWER

- **Jharkhand** from Bihar (2000)
- **Chhattisgarh** from Madhya Pradesh (2000)
- **Uttarakhand** from Uttar Pradesh (2000)

(Also: Telangana from Andhra Pradesh, 2014.)

🤔 **Think · Language policy and Centre-State relations**

? **Why Hindi? Why not Bangla or Telugu?**

✔ ANSWER

- Hindi is the mother tongue of the **largest group** of Indians (about 44 per cent in 2011), more than any other language (Bengali about 8 per cent, Telugu about 7 per cent).
- So it was made the **official language**, but **not a national language**.
- Bangla, Telugu and 20 others are Scheduled Languages, States use their own official languages, and Hindi cannot be imposed on them.

Cartoons

Two cartoons: 'The States Plead for More Powers' and 'Perils of Running a Coalition Government'. Should the State go to the Centre with a begging bowl? How can the leader of a coalition keep the partners of government satisfied?

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- **Begging bowl:** No. In a federation States have their **own powers and sources of revenue** fixed by the Constitution. They should get their fair share as a right, not as charity from the Centre. The first cartoon criticises the early years when the Centre held most powers and funds.
- **Coalition:** The second cartoon shows the coalition leader sitting on many 'bombs' (partners) that can blow up the government. The leader can keep partners satisfied by:

- making a **common minimum programme** together;
- **consulting** partners before big decisions and giving them fair shares in ministries;
- **respecting** the interests of regional parties and State governments.

? **Are you suggesting that regionalism is good for our democracy? Are you serious?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Regionalism that **respects the autonomy of States** has been good for Indian democracy:

- Regional parties gave a voice to the needs of their States.
- Coalition governments at the Centre after 1990 created a culture of **power sharing** and respect for State governments.
- The Centre could no longer dismiss State governments arbitrarily.

But regionalism that turns into hatred of other regions or demands to break away is harmful. Balanced regionalism within national unity strengthens federalism.

🧪 Activity · Linguistic diversity of India

1 **Make a bar or pie chart on the basis of the table of Scheduled Languages (Census 2011).**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Draw bars (or pie slices) for the largest languages from the table and group the rest as 'Others':

Language	Speakers (%)
Hindi	43.63
Bengali	8.03
Marathi	6.86
Telugu	6.70
Tamil	5.70
Gujarati	4.58
Urdu	4.19
Kannada	3.61
Odia	3.10
Malayalam	2.88
Punjabi	2.74
Others	about 7.9

The chart shows that no single language is the mother tongue of a majority (even Hindi is below 50 per cent).

2 **Prepare a map of linguistic diversity of India by shading the region where each of these languages is spoken.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

On an outline map of India shade, for example:

- Hindi: Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, Delhi

- Bengali: West Bengal, Tripura · Assamese, Bodo: Assam · Odia: Odisha
- Marathi: Maharashtra · Konkani: Goa · Gujarati: Gujarat · Punjabi: Punjab
- Telugu: Andhra Pradesh, Telangana · Tamil: Tamil Nadu · Kannada: Karnataka · Malayalam: Kerala
- Kashmiri, Dogri: Jammu and Kashmir · Manipuri: Manipur · Nepali: Sikkim · Maithili: north Bihar · Santali: Jharkhand

Use a different colour for each language and add a key.

3 **Find out about any three languages that are spoken in India but are not included in this table.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Three non-Scheduled Languages:

- **Bhili/Bhilodi:** spoken by Bhil tribes in Madhya Pradesh, Gujarat, Rajasthan and Maharashtra.
- **Gondi:** spoken by Gond tribes in Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Maharashtra and Telangana.
- **Tulu:** spoken in coastal Karnataka (Mangaluru, Udupi) and northern Kerala.

(Others: Khasi in Meghalaya, Kurukh in Jharkhand.)

Let us revise · Linguistic States (Ramachandra Guha)

? **Guha argues that linguistic States have strengthened Indian unity and saved India from a worse fate ('One language: 14 or 15 nations'). Take the example of your own state or any other state affected by linguistic reorganisation and write a short note for or against this argument.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

For the argument (example: Andhra Pradesh):

- The Telugu-speaking people demanded their own State; after the protests, Andhra State was formed in 1953, and the SRC report of 1956 created States on the basis of language.
- People got government, courts and schools in their own language, so administration became easier and closer to people.
- Telugu speakers feel proud to be both **Telugu and Indian**; there has been no demand to leave India.
- If their language had been ignored, anger could have grown into separatism, as happened with Tamils in Sri Lanka.

Conclusion: Linguistic States accommodated diversity and made India more united, as Guha says. Some disputes between States (over borders or river water) remain, but they are settled within the Constitution.

🤔 Think · Decentralisation in India

? **Prime Minister runs the country, Chief Minister runs the state. Logically, the chairperson of Zilla Parishad should run the district. Why does the D.M. or Collector administer the district?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- The District Magistrate/Collector is an officer of the **State government** (an IAS officer). The district is a unit of State administration, so the State runs it through the DM.
- The DM looks after law and order, revenue, elections and State schemes in the district.
- The zilla parishad is a local government body; State governments have **not transferred enough powers and resources** to it.
- This shows we are still a long way from real self-government at the district level.

? **What do these newspaper clippings say about efforts of decentralisation in India? (Headlines: 'Democracy for sale in TN, highest bidders get Panchayat posts'; 'States oppose direct funding of panchayats'; 'For Rs 250, justice in a village: Bill'; 'Women pradhans bring winds of change'; 'Over 1m women elected to panchayats')**

✔ ANSWER

Positive efforts:

- Over 10 lakh **women** have been elected to panchayats because one-third seats are reserved; women pradhans are bringing change.
- A Bill proposed **Nyaya Panchayats** to give cheap justice in villages.

Problems:

- In Tamil Nadu panchayat posts were **auctioned** to the highest bidder, which defeats democracy.
- **States oppose** giving funds directly to panchayats; they do not want to share power and money.

So decentralisation has deepened democracy, but it still faces many difficulties.

Find out

Find out about the local government in your village or town: names of your panch/ward member, sarpanch, panchayat samiti, zilla parishad chairperson, and the last gram sabha meeting (date, attendance). In urban areas: your municipal councillor, municipal chairperson or mayor, and the budget of your municipality and its major items of spending.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Model record (fill in real names from your area):

Item	Details
Ward member / panch	(name), Ward No. 4
Sarpanch	(name)
Panchayat samiti / block	(name of block)
Zilla parishad chairperson	(name)
Last gram sabha	(date), about 150 people attended

In a city: note the councillor of your ward, the mayor or municipal chairperson, and major budget items such as roads, water supply, sanitation, street lights, schools and health centres. Ask at the panchayat office, municipal office or website.

📝 Exercises

1 **Locate the following States on a blank outline political map of India: Manipur, Sikkim, Chhattisgarh and Goa.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- **Manipur:** north-east India, east of Assam, bordering Myanmar (capital Imphal).
- **Sikkim:** small State in the north, between Nepal and Bhutan, north of West Bengal (capital Gangtok).
- **Chhattisgarh:** central-east India, east of Madhya Pradesh, west of Odisha (capital Raipur).

- **Goa:** small State on the west coast, between Maharashtra and Karnataka (capital Panaji).

2 **Identify and shade three federal countries (other than India) on a blank outline political map of the world.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Shade, for example:

- **USA** (North America)
- **Australia** (Australia continent)
- **Brazil** (South America)

(Others: Canada, Germany, Russia, Switzerland, Belgium, Nigeria.)

3 **Point out one feature in the practice of federalism in India that is similar to and one feature that is different from that of Belgium.**

✔ ANSWER

- **Similar:** Both are **'holding together'** federations. Power is shared between the central government and State/regional governments, and the regional governments have constitutional powers that the Centre cannot take away on its own.

- **Different:** In Belgium the **central government has equal numbers of Dutch and French-speaking ministers** and there is a third **community government** elected by one language community. India has no such community government; instead it has a third tier of **local government** (panchayats and municipalities), and the **Centre is more powerful** than the States.

4 **What is the main difference between a federal form of government and a unitary one? Explain with an example.**

✔ ANSWER

- In a **unitary** system there is only one level of government, or the sub-units are **subordinate** to the central government. The Centre can order provincial or local governments.
- In a **federal** system power is divided between the Centre and the States by the constitution. The Centre **cannot order** a State; each level has its own powers and is separately answerable to the people.

Example: In **Sri Lanka** (unitary), the national government has all the powers. In **India** (federal), a State government decides on police (State List) and the Centre cannot order it.

5 **State any two differences between the local government before and after the Constitutional amendment in 1992.**

✔ ANSWER

Before 1992	After 1992
Elections to local bodies were **not held regularly**	It is **constitutionally mandatory** to hold regular elections
Local bodies had **no powers or resources** of their own; directly under State control	States must **share some powers and revenue** with them
No reserved seats for weaker sections and women	Seats reserved for **SC, ST, OBC**; at least **one-third for women**
No independent body for their elections	A **State Election Commission** conducts the elections

6 **Fill in the blanks: Since the United States is a ____ type of federation, all the constituent States have equal powers and States are ____ vis-à-vis the federal government. But India is a ____ type of federation and some States have more power than others. In India, the ____ government has more powers.**

✔ ANSWER

Since the United States is a **coming together** type of federation, all the constituent States have equal powers and States are **strong** vis-à-vis the federal government. But India is a **holding together** type of federation and some States have more power than others. In India, the **Central (Union)** government has more powers.

7 **Three reactions to India's language policy. Give an argument and an example to support any of these positions.**

Sangeeta: The policy of accommodation has strengthened national unity.

Arman: Language-based States have divided us by making everyone conscious of their language.

Harish: This policy has only helped to consolidate the dominance of English over all other languages.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Supporting Sangeeta:

- **Argument:** India gave no language the status of national language, recognised 22 Scheduled Languages, let States use their own official languages and did not impose Hindi. People felt respected, so they stayed united.

- **Example:** When Tamil Nadu protested against Hindi in 1965, the Centre agreed to continue English along with Hindi. The anger ended, and Tamil Nadu remains firmly part of India. In contrast, Sri Lanka's 'Sinhala only' policy led to civil war.
- Linguistic States like Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka and Maharashtra also made administration easier and people proud to be both, say, Kannadiga and Indian.

8 **The distinguishing feature of a federal government is: (a) National government gives some powers to the provincial governments. (b) Power is distributed among the legislature, executive and judiciary. (c) Elected officials exercise supreme power in the government. (d) Governmental power is divided between different levels of government.**

✔ ANSWER

(d) Governmental power is divided between different levels of government. (In (a) powers are 'given' and can be taken back, which is unitary; (b) is separation of powers; (c) is democracy.)

9 **Group these subjects under the Union, State and Concurrent Lists: A. Defence; B. Police; C. Agriculture; D. Education; E. Banking; F.**

Forests; G. Communications; H. Trade; I. Marriages

✔ ANSWER

List	Subjects
Union List	A. Defence, E. Banking, G. Communications
State List	B. Police, C. Agriculture, H. Trade
Concurrent List	D. Education, F. Forests, I. Marriages

10 **Which of the following pairs is not correctly matched? (a) State government – State List (b) Central government – Union List (c) Central and State governments – Concurrent List (d) Local governments – Residuary powers**

✔ ANSWER

(d) Local governments – Residuary powers. Residuary powers belong to the **Union Government**, not local governments.

11 **Match List I with List II:**

List I	List II
1. Union of India	A. Prime Minister
2. State	B. Sarpanch
3. Municipal Corporation	C. Governor
4. Gram Panchayat	D. Mayor

Codes (1 2 3 4): (a) D A B C (b) B C D A (c) A C D B (d) C D A B

✔ ANSWER

(c) A C D B — Union of India: Prime Minister; State: Governor; Municipal Corporation: Mayor; Gram Panchayat: Sarpanch.

12 **Consider the following statements:**

A. In a federation, the powers of the federal and provincial governments are clearly demarcated.

B. India is a federation because the powers of the Union and State Governments are specified in the Constitution and they have exclusive jurisdiction on their respective subjects.

C. Sri Lanka is a federation because the country is divided into provinces.

D. India is no longer a federation because some powers of the States have been devolved to the local government bodies.

Which are correct? (a) A, B and C (b) A, C and D (c) A and B only (d) B and C only

✔ ANSWER

(c) A and B only. C is wrong: Sri Lanka is practically a unitary system. D is wrong: giving powers to local bodies adds a third tier and strengthens federalism.

🎉 **Chapter 2 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**